

Message from the Project Director, DSACS



Dear readers,

Every era has its scourges but when people unite and decide to fight back, they can survive all problems.

AIDS is one of the challenges faced by all modern societies including India

If we can educate our population, make them aware of the risks of their own sexual behaviour and the risks involved in other ways, which are not related to sexual behaviour, we can greatly reduce the incidence of AIDS.

Also, once a person has been tested and found HIV positive, life does not come to an end. It has to be lived differently. Like many other lifetime diseases such as diabetes, blood pressure and illnesses related to the heart, lungs, kidneys or other vital organs, a person with HIV/AIDS has also to take medicine regularly and for a long time. Unlike other infections, AIDS is not transmitted through social contact, provided no sexual contact has taken place and a person who has tested positive is not necessarily a person of bad character who needs to be socially ostracized.

We have to understand the problems posed by AIDS, not only in medical but also in social terms. Only then can we overcome it as a nation and as a society

This message from me is to sections of our people

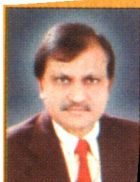
To those who are HIV negative, I say: follow safe behaviour patterns

To the HIV positive I say: Life is not over. Live it well with medical help

To those living with an HIV positive person, I say: Take care, and to everybody, I say: Let us educate ourselves, and let us fight AIDS, not each other

Rashmi Krishnan

Message from the Addl. Project Director, DSACS



Dear readers,

HIV Infection has taken the form of a global pandemic. India is also experiencing an epidemic of HIV infection with an overall prevalence of < 1%. The Indian epidemic is experiencing a change. The epidemic is spreading from high risk to general population, urban to rural population & more and more number of females are being infected. The infection is associated with danger of spread of sex partner/s & un-born baby through materno-fetal transmission. The cost of treatment is very high and there is a high mortality rate. However, HIV infection can be easily prevented by use of condoms, screening of all blood donors for HIV infection, using disposable needles for injections and screening all pregnant women for HIV infection. Therefore it is moral duty of each one of us to take steps to prevent the spread of AIDS

Further, DSACS is getting tremendous support from Delhi Network of HIV Positive People (DNP+) in organising various HIV preventive and curative services in Delhi. We all know that HIV infection does not spread through shaking hands, hugging, kissing, eating together or sharing same room with an HIV positive person. Therefore, the people with HIV/AIDS should not be discriminated and should receive affection and care from the society

Dr. A.K. Gupta

HIV/AIDS Services-The need of the Hour

Delhi with a population of more than 14 million is highly vulnerable to HIV/AIDS. As per available HIV surveillance data, the infection is prevalent in almost all districts of Delhi. A number of factors like population growth, increase in migrant population, large number of High Risk Subgroups like street children, female sex workers, migrant labours, men having sex with men, intravenous drug users and truckers make the inhabitants highly vulnerable to HIV infection.

The first case of AIDS was reported in Delhi in 1988 and since then it has increased to 5929 by Sept, 2007. To reduce the spread of HIV among all sections of the society, Delhi State AIDS Control Society, an autonomous body of Delhi Govt, is presently implementing IIIrd Phase of National AIDS Control programme, a five year Project (2007-12), with the following objectives:

- Prevention of new infections in high risk groups (through Targeted intervention by NGOs) and general population (through mainstreaming, condom promotion, treatment of sexually transmitted infections and promotion of safe blood transfusion practices)
 - Providing greater care, support & treatment to people living with HIV/AIDS (through Community Care, Drop-in and Anti-retroviral Treatment centres)
 - Strengthening the infrastructure and human resource for prevention, care, support and treatment.
 - Strengthening the nationwide Strategic Information Management System.
- An early diagnosis of HIV infection is crucial to prevent its spread in community and for timely care, support and treatment. The patients with history of following symptoms should be suspected for an underlying HIV infection:
- Prolonged fever,
 - Recurrent diarrhoea,
 - Enlarged glands in neck & other regions,
 - Weight loss,
 - Recurrent oral ulcerations, oral thrush
 - Recurrent episodes of pneumonia, pyoderma, bone infections
 - Tuberculosis and
 - Serious infections of the brain etc.

